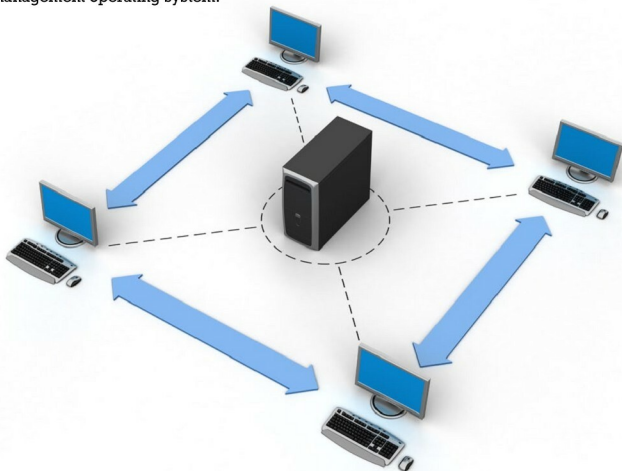


Get Started with Openfiler

In this article we introduce you to Openfiler, which is an open source storage management operating system.



Openfiler is a network storage OS that supports file-based Network Attached Storage (NAS) and block-based Storage Area Networking (SAN) functionality in a single unified framework. NAS can be mapped as network drives to share on servers; it provides storage and file systems. NAS supports NFS, CIFS, SMB, etc, and it is primarily used by SMBs. It has a storage capacity up to a few TBs. There is no need for specialised expertise and training to configure and maintain NAS.

SAN can be used as a disk-in-disk and volume management utility. It is block-based storage and supports protocols such as SCSI, Fiber Channel, iSCSI, ATA over Ethernet and HyperSCSI, and is primarily used by large organisations. It has storage capacity up to many TBs. And as in the case of NAS, no specialised expertise and training is required to configure and maintain SANs too.

Any x86 or x86_64 industry standard server can be transformed into an effective multi-protocol network

storage appliance with insightful Web-based management user interface. CIFS and NFS types of file-based storage networking protocols ensure compatibility across multiple platforms in homogeneous networks - with client support for various OSs such as Linux, Windows and UNIX. Fibre channel and iSCSI target features provide exceptional integration capabilities for virtual environments such as Xen and VMware.

Openfiler is a free OS that was created by Xinit Systems, and is based on the rPath Linux distribution. It is licensed under the GNU General Public License version 2. Its stable release is Openfiler NAS/SAN Appliance, version 2.3 (Final Release). It supports platform i386/AMD64. The Openfiler distribution is available as an installable ISO image to be deployed on a pre-installed disk image or bare-metal in environments such as Xen, VMware, QEMU and Parallels. Installable images are available for x86_64 architectures. The following download options are available at <http://www>.